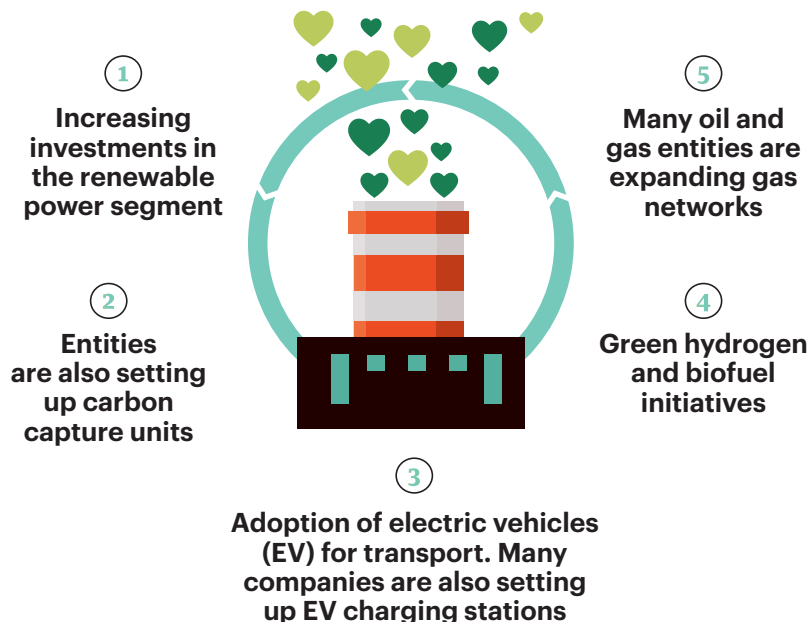


CORPORATE INITIATIVES FOR DECARBONISATION



SOURCE ICRA

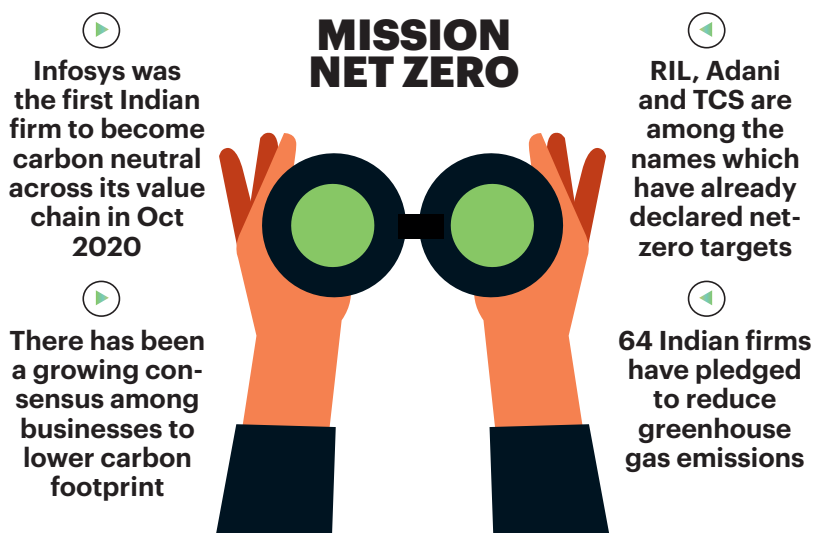
sion (at 1.77 tonnes in 2020, it was about 1/8th of the US and 1/4th of China, while Qatar and New Caledonia were the top contributors at 37.02 tonnes and 30.45 tonnes, respectively). Still, it is never too early to start. The top contributors to India's total carbon emissions include power (above 40 per cent); steel and cement (25 per cent); transportation (15 per cent); and agriculture (14 per cent), say industry experts. Many industries have implemented RE projects like putting up solar-based power plants and replaced fossil fuels with biomass/agro-waste. Metal industries, too, are shifting to gas-based power plants.

For instance, Vedanta, with interests in power generation, oil & gas, and metals, plans to use 2.5 GW of round-the-clock RE for operations by 2030. "The focus on renewables will lead to a more mineral-intensive world since electric cars require six times more minerals than conventional cars," explains Sunil Duggal, Group CEO and Chief Safety Officer at Vedanta. The company has partnered with academic institutions to research hydrogen fuel in steelmaking furnaces. "If successful, it will reduce our dependence on coke," he says. Given the industries it operates in, its net-zero goal is set for 2050.

As a fast-growing economy, controlling India's emissions is a challenging task, but companies have been at it for over a decade. Cement major UltraTech has been converting municipal solid waste (MSW) into fuel pellets to be used in cement kilns since 2007. With tie-ups with 80 municipal corporations in the country, UltraTech used 74.19 tonnes of MSW in FY21. "We are scaling up our investments and... increasing the share of RE and the use of alternative fuels and raw materials," says a spokesperson. The company aims to be net zero by 2050.

The textiles sector, meanwhile,

MISSION NET ZERO



1.77 TONNES

INDIA'S PER CAPITA CARBON EMISSION IN 2020, WHICH WAS ABOUT 1/8TH THAT OF THE US AND 1/4TH THAT OF CHINA, ACCORDING TO OUR WORLD IN DATA